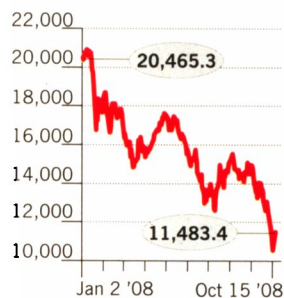


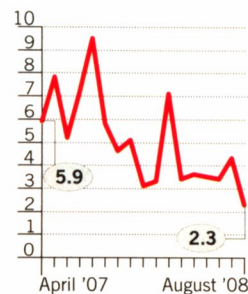


SLIDE RULE **Down for the Count: All the major economic indices are south-bound**

SENSEX

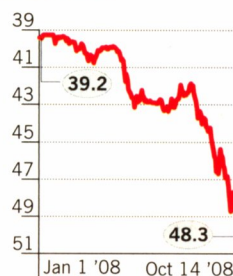


IIP*



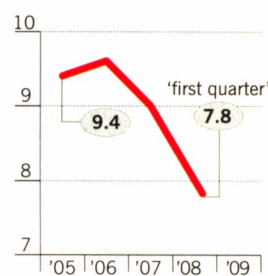
Index of Industrial Production

RUPEE VS DOLLAR



Figures are rupee value against dollar

GDP



Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY

WEALTH WIPED OUT IN THE 10 MONTHS SINCE THE PEAK OF JANUARY 10.

issuing pink slips to survive. Almost alphabetically, aviation heads the queue in issuing severance slips as the sector—with \$6 billion in revenues—is set to lose \$2 billion this year, triggering an unusual alliance between bitter competitors Jet and Kingfisher. It's not just Jet or the aviation sector. Cholamandalam DBS Finance, which manages assets of Rs 7,000 crore, has announced the closure of 50 branches. Others in the race downhill include infotech companies and realty outfits. Irrational exuberance has been replaced with a fear that could turn into self-fulfilling prophecy.

What is remarkable is that India's best brains

trust is involved in managing the crisis. Besides Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, Finance Minister P. Chidambaram and Planning Commission Deputy Chairman Montek Singh Ahluwalia, there's RBI Governor D. Subbarao, monetary guru C. Rangarajan and former RBI Governor Y.V. Reddy. But such is the crisis of confidence that despite the A Team at the helm, markets continue to be nervous. Between October 8 and October 14, the RBI pumped Rs 60,000 crore into the market. Yet, the stock market tanked by 674 points on October 15, triggering yet another CRR (cash reserve ratio or money required to be kept free by banks) cut late at night bringing it



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